

Skills

Assisting with a Bedpan

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Performed hand hygiene.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to patient and family.	☐	☐	☐	
Provided for patient privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified patient using two identifiers.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Applied gloves, gathered supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Placed bedpan under running warm water, dried bedpan, did not allow to become too hot.	☐	☐	☐	
Ensured top side rails of bed are in up position, raised bed to comfortable working height.	☐	☐	☐	
If patient could assist with getting onto bedpan: 1. Assisted patient into appropriate position, observed for presence of drains, dressings, IV fluids, and traction, obtained additional personnel if needed. 2. Moved top bed linens out of the way, took care not to expose patient. 3. Instructed patient on how to flex knees and raise hips. 4. Placed the hand of the health care team member, who is assisting the patient, closer to the patient's head with palm up and under the patient's sacrum to assist with lifting. Asked patient to bend knees and raise hips, used other hand to slip bedpan under patient, did not use force. 5. Positioned fracture pan appropriately if used. 6. Asked patient to use overhead trapeze frame if present. 7. Ensured toilet paper is within reach, instructed patient on how to properly wipe.	☐	☐	☐	
Ensured bed is in lowest position, raised upper side rail.	☐	☐	☐	

Ensured patient knows where call light is located, instructed patient to use it when finished. ☐ ☐ ☐

Allowed patient to be alone, monitored patient status, responded promptly to call light. ☐ ☐ ☐

When patient finished, performed hand hygiene, applied clean gloves. ☐ ☐ ☐

Removed bedpan properly: ☐ ☐ ☐

1. Placed beside chair within reach of bed, draped it with waterproof pad.
 2. Moved top bed linens out of the way, exposed patient as little as possible.
 3. Determined if patient was able to cleanse perineal area, used toilet tissue or disposable washcloths if assistance was necessary.
 4. Deposited soiled tissue in appropriate container.
 5. Asked patient to flex knees and lift buttocks, at same time, placed the assisting health care team member's hand farther from the patient on the side of the bedpan to support the bedpan and place the assisting hand closer to the patient under the sacrum to assist with lifting, removed bedpan properly, covered bedpan with towel.
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Changed soiled linens, removed and disposed of gloves, returned patient to comfortable position. ☐ ☐ ☐

Placed bed in lowest position, allowed patient to perform hand hygiene, ensured patient has access to call light, water, and personal items, performed hand hygiene. ☐ ☐ ☐

If patient is immobile or has mobility restrictions: ☐ ☐ ☐

1. Applied clean gloves, raised bed to comfortable working height, positioned bed appropriately.
 2. Moved top linens are necessary to turn patient, minimized exposure.
 3. Lowered side rail, helped patient roll onto side toward the opposite side rail, placed bedpan on patient's buttocks and pushed into mattress, ensured proper orientation of bedpan.
 4. Rolled patient properly on the bedpan, did not force bedpan under patient.
 5. Placed pillow or towel under patient's lumbar.
 6. Covered patient for warmth, raised bed to appropriate sitting level for patient.
 7. Asked patient to bend knees if appropriate.
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Allowed patient to be alone, monitored status, responded to call light. ☐ ☐ ☐

Performed hand hygiene, applied clean gloves. ☐ ☐ ☐

Removed bedpan appropriately:

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1. Moved top bed linens out of the way, exposed patient as little as possible.
2. Determined if patient was able to wipe own perineal area, assisted if necessary.
3. Lowered head of bed, helped patient roll to side toward the opposite side rail, held bedpan flat and steady, covered bedpan with towel, cleansed patient's perineal area appropriately if necessary.
4. Discarded soiled tissue appropriately, allowed patient to perform hand hygiene after cleansing perineum.

Noted characteristics of patient's stool and urine.

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Wore gloves when emptying contents of bedpan, cleaned and stored bedpan according to agency policy.

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Set aside used equipment in an appropriate location for subsequent use when required. Disposed of soiled linens appropriately.

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Removed and discarded gloves, performed hand hygiene.

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Documented amount, color, and characteristics of stool and tolerance of getting on and off the bedpan.

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Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____